

Speaking: interview, short talk and discussion

Component 3 · interview + talk + discussion · 40 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

Learning focus

Answer fully, organise a short talk, listen and respond flexibly, and use intelligible pronunciation and intonation.

Develop an interview answer

Move beyond a single fact: give a reason, example or consequence. A brief pause to think is natural. If you misunderstand a question, politely ask for repetition or clarification. Interview, talk and discussion are assessed together.

Worked example

Question: “What do you do at weekends?” → “I usually visit the sports centre because I can meet friends there. Last Saturday we tried a new class, which was harder than I expected.”

Build a short talk without written notes

In the test, the candidate sees a card and has up to one minute to prepare; written notes are not allowed. Use a mental structure: introduce the topic, describe an experience, explain a benefit and a difficulty, then conclude. Speak for a sustained period and develop ideas naturally.

Worked example

“I learned to cook a simple meal ... At first I measured ingredients slowly ... Now I can adapt the recipe ... One difficulty was timing ... I would recommend learning with a friend.”

Discuss, listen and self-correct

In Part 3, respond to the actual question, then extend or qualify an idea. Intonation can show certainty, interest and contrast. Small mistakes can be corrected smoothly while maintaining conversation. The official four criteria each carry 10 marks: grammar, vocabulary, development and pronunciation.

Worked example

“I agree to some extent because ... However, for a difficult skill, feedback from another person may be more useful than a video.”

Practice paper

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Original FagusED practice. Answer on the lines provided. The number of marks is shown in square brackets.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Timed rehearsal

With a teacher or partner, rehearse the interview for 2–3 minutes, allow up to 1 minute of silent preparation for the short talk (no written notes), then complete a talk and 3–4-minute discussion. Record the practice for feedback if convenient. The formal test lasts approximately 10–15 minutes, including introduction and warm-up.

Part 1 • Interview

Topic: free time and routines. Ask: What do you usually do after school? When do you prefer to meet friends? Describe an activity you tried recently. Why might a regular routine help you learn a new skill?

Example developed answer: “I usually practise playing the guitar after school. I choose that time because the house is quiet, and I can remember what I learned the day before. Last month I started learning with a friend, which made it easier to keep going.”

Part 2 • Short talk card

Learning a practical skill

Talk about a practical skill you have learned or would like to learn. Describe how someone could begin; explain one challenge; say how useful this skill might be in the future. You have up to one minute to read the card and prepare mentally. Do not write notes during the timed simulation.

Example outline for study after the rehearsal: cooking one meal → learning with a relative → timing several steps → greater independence. In the assessed talk, make connections and examples rather than reading an outline.

Part 3 • Discussion

Teacher prompts: Are practical skills best learned at school or at home? Can videos replace advice from an experienced person? Why do some people give up when they are learning something new? Which skills might become more useful in the future? Ask follow-ups based on the candidate’s actual ideas.

Example response: “Videos can show the basic steps and let you pause, but I would still want feedback from somebody who can notice my mistakes. For example, a recipe video cannot always tell me why my dough feels different.”

Observation and feedback

Grammar: range, control and clarity [/10]

Vocabulary: precision and variety [/10]

Development: relevant answers, extended ideas and sustained interaction [/10]

Pronunciation: intelligibility and purposeful intonation [/10]

Total [/40]. Feedback: identify one successful development, one language target and one pronunciation target. Listen for improvement after a second rehearsal; a teacher uses the current official level descriptors for assessment.

Useful phrases

“One reason is ...”; “For example ...”; “I partly agree, although ...”; “Could you repeat that, please?”
These phrases support communication when they introduce genuine ideas. Do not memorise a complete answer for every question.

Assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (Count-in Speaking) 0511 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/721343-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages, prompts and scripts by FagusED. June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user informed presentation. Independent practice material, not an official Cambridge paper.